

Sugar Swap Recipes

Swaps by trigger, the craving-buster tea, and a 7-day mood & energy tracker · Module 2, Training 2

Why swaps beat willpower

Stress raises cortisol; cortisol drives sugar cravings (Adam & Epel, *Physiology & Behavior*). Sugar spikes then crashes, and the crash is itself a stressor. High glycemic-load diets were linked to ovulatory infertility (Chavarro et al., *European Journal of Clinical Nutrition*) and sugar-sweetened drinks to insulin resistance (Malik et al., *Diabetes Care*) and lower monthly fecundability in both partners (Hatch et al., *Epidemiology*). A swap interrupts the loop; willpower only argues with it. Most urges peak and pass within about twenty minutes (urge surfing; Bowen & Marlatt, *Psychology of Addictive Behaviors*).

Pick the swap that matches your strongest trigger (from your Module 1 worksheet)

MY TRIGGER BUCKET	THE SWAP	WHY IT WORKS
Physiological (afternoon crash, after a carb-heavy lunch, short sleep)	Protein-first breakfast; sweet + protein + fat (never sweet alone)	Slows sugar absorption, no spike → no crash
Environmental (candy dish, ads, the couch show)	Rearrange: berries at eye level, sweets on a high shelf or out of the house; berry-basil sparkling water in the fridge door	Cues drive reactivity (Boswell & Kober, <i>Obesity Reviews</i>); change the cue, not yourself
Emotional (after hard conversations, late at night)	Craving-buster tea + two-minute hand-on-heart pause: "What do I actually need?"	The ritual outlasts the urge; addresses the need instead of numbing it
Any	15-minute brisk walk before deciding	Reduced chocolate cravings and snacking (Oh & Taylor, <i>Appetite</i>)

Swap recipes

1. BERRIES & WALNUTS (INSTEAD OF CANDY)

1 cup mixed berries (fresh or frozen) · small handful walnuts · optional 1 tbsp plain full-fat yogurt · pinch of cinnamon. Combine in a bowl. Protein, fat, fiber, color.

2. DARK CHOCOLATE & ALMONDS (INSTEAD OF A MILK-CHOCOLATE BAR)

2 squares 85% dark chocolate · 10 almonds. Eat the chocolate slowly using the mindful first bite from Module 1. Keep the bar in the freezer; frozen chocolate is eaten slower.

3. APPLE WITH NUT BUTTER (INSTEAD OF A PASTRY)

1 apple, sliced · 1 tbsp almond or peanut butter (ingredients: nuts, salt only) · sprinkle of chia.

4. BABY STEPS SMOOTHIE (INSTEAD OF A SWEET COFFEE DRINK)

Big handful spinach · 1 cup frozen berries · ½ avocado · ½ cup plain full-fat Greek yogurt or kefir · 1 tbsp ground flax · small handful walnuts · 1 cup water or unsweetened milk. Blend. Serves 2.

5. YOGURT "DESSERT" (INSTEAD OF ICE CREAM)

½ cup plain full-fat Greek yogurt · ½ cup frozen cherries, thawed 5 minutes · 1 tsp cocoa · a few pistachios. Stir. In winter, warm the cherries first.

6. PROTEIN-FIRST BREAKFASTS (ROTATE THREE, NEVER THINK ABOUT BREAKFAST AGAIN)

- Two eggs scrambled with spinach, avocado on the side
- Plain Greek yogurt with berries, walnuts and ground flax
- The Baby Steps smoothie (make the dry ingredients into a jar the night before)

7. BERRY-BASIL SPARKLING WATER (INSTEAD OF SODA)

Muddle 4 raspberries and 2 basil leaves in a glass; top with plain sparkling water and ice.

8. CYNTHIA'S CRAVING-BUSTER TEA

1 cinnamon stick · 3–4 slices fresh ginger · a drop of pure vanilla extract · optional rooibos teabag · 300 ml just-boiled water. Steep 5 minutes. The four minutes of making it is the point: most cravings are shorter than the kettle.

Tea safety: skip licorice-root teas while trying to conceive or pregnant. Cinnamon, ginger, peppermint, rooibos and chamomile are gentle choices; check with your doctor about herbal teas if you have a medical condition or take medication. Artificial sweeteners keep the sweet expectation alive; whole-food swaps are preferred.

Two rules

1. **One swap this week**, matched to your strongest trigger. Not all of them.
2. **If you also eat the sugary thing, you still did the swap.** Tick the box. Grace over guilt.

7-day mood & energy tracker (30 XP)

Track two numbers, not weight and not calories. **Energy at 3 p.m.** and **mood at 9 p.m.**, each 1–10. Note the swap you used and anything you noticed.

DAY	SWAP I USED	ENERGY 3 P.M. (1–10)	MOOD 9 P.M. (1–10)	HOURS SLEPT	NOTES (CRAVING STRENGTH, WHAT HAPPENED)
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					

End of week: my afternoon energy trend was ☐ up ☐ flat ☐ down · my strongest craving day was Day ____ and it followed ____ hours of sleep · the swap I'll keep: _____

For couples

Sugar is a shared environment. Agree on one thing: sweets out of sight (high shelf, car, not the counter). No policing; just the shelf.

Share in the forum (20 XP)

Post which swap you chose and one sentence about how your three o'clock felt.

Educational content only, not medical advice. Always consult your doctor or a qualified health professional before changing supplements, diet, exercise or detox practices, especially while trying to conceive.